

Ateneo de Davao University
Emilio Jacinto Street, Davao City



AI Tool Exploration and Prompt Engineering

Prepared by:
Jhohn Bennidict Estrella
Bachelor of Science in Computer Science
21st Century IT Skills | CS2A

Submitted to:
Sir. Gabriel I. Quibod

2st Semester
AY 2025-2026

April 14, 2026

AI Tool Overview

Name of AI Tool:

NotebookLLM

Purpose / Domain:

NotebookLLM is an AI-powered tool designed for the academic research and knowledge organization domain. It allows users to upload documents such as PDFs and interact with them using AI to generate summaries, notes, explanations, and insights. The tool focuses on helping users better understand complex materials by transforming raw content into structured and digestible information.

Why I Chose It:

I chose NotebookLLM because it is highly effective for handling multiple academic documents at once, making it ideal for note-taking and studying. As a student, I often work with several PDFs, and this tool helps streamline the process of extracting and organizing important information. Additionally, NotebookLLM is well-suited for demonstrating prompt engineering because its outputs vary significantly depending on how instructions are given. This makes it a strong example of how prompt design can influence the clarity, depth, and structure of AI-generated notes.

Original Prompt

Create a note for these 3 PDF files. Make sure not to skip any major details. Highlight the important texts. Do not oversimplify the notes, add as much information as possible.

The LLM Output:

Comprehensive Note on the Life, Works, and Legacy of Jose Rizal

I. The Task of Making Rizal Obsolete

Renato Constantino argues that the continued validity of Rizal's teachings is a measure of a lack of national greatness, as it proves that the social ills he described in the 19th century—such as corruption, ignorance, and opportunism—still persist today.

- **The Social Mirror:** Rizal's works serve as a mirror reflecting the vices and defects of Philippine society. However, this mirror was intended to reflect the society of *his* time; the fact that it still reflects *ours* is an indictment of our lack of progress.
- **The Goal of Obsolescence:** To truly honor Rizal, the nation must eradicate the ills he decried, thereby making his criticisms "obsolete" as a reflection of the present and turning them into a mere mirror of the past.
- **Modern Parallels in Rizal's Characters:**
 - **Tulisanes in Cadillacs:** Simoun's observation that the real "tulisanes" (bandits) are not in the mountains but in the towns and cities is reflected in modern corrupt officials, dishonest civil servants, and profiteers.
 - **Don Timoteo Pelaez:** Represents devious business practices where individuals profit from government decrees.
 - **One-Armed Bandits:** Modern-day "fixers" and influence peddlers mirror the opportunistic characters in Rizal's novels.
 - **Social Archetypes:** The modern world still hosts the Dona Victorinas (who belittle Filipinos to pretend they are Occidental), the Capitan Tiagos (who fawn upon power for profit), and the Senor Pastas (who live in compromise and conformism).

II. Veneration Without Understanding: The National Hero Controversy

Constantino challenges the uncritical "hagiolatry" of Rizal, noting that unlike the heroes of other nations, Rizal did not lead the revolution that birthed his nation—he actually repudiated it.

- **Repudiation of the Revolution:** In his December 15, 1896 manifesto, Rizal condemned the Katipunan's uprising as "criminal" and "absurd," believing that reforms must come from "above" (the elite/Spain) rather than from "below" (the masses).
- **American Sponsorship:** Rizal's status as the pre-eminent national hero was significantly abetted by the US colonial administration (specifically under Governor William Howard Taft). The Americans favored Rizal over leaders like Bonifacio or Aguinaldo because:
 - He was "safely dead" and could not voice anti-American sentiments.
 - He was a reformer, not a separatist, which aligned with American colonial policy of "tutelage".
 - He represented the conservative ilustrado class that the Americans were cultivating for leadership.
- **The Role of the Hero in History:** Constantino posits that while Rizal accelerated the maturation of the nationalist struggle, the Revolution would have occurred even without him due to historical forces and economic developments.

III. The Evolution of the "Filipino" and Class Limitations

- **The Term "Filipino":** Originally, the term referred only to creoles (Spaniards born in the Philippines). The natives were called "indios". Rizal and the ilustrados eventually appropriated the name "Filipino" for the natives, which was a significant anti-colonial victory in the realm of consciousness.
- **Ilustrado Limitations:** Rizal was a "limited Filipino" whose education and property separated him from the masses. He believed in liberty as a "medal for good behavior" to be granted after education, rather than as an inherent national right.
- **Intellectual Captivity and Language:** Rizal warned that adopting a foreign language (Spanish then, English now) as a primary medium would lead to intellectual captivity, the loss of national originality, and the "stifling" of native culture.

IV. Beyond the Icon: Humanization, Myth, and Spirit

Modern scholarship attempts to move beyond the "sanctified" image of Rizal to understand him as a human being and a cultural phenomenon.

- Rizal Without the Overcoat: Ambeth Ocampo seeks to humanize Rizal by examining original manuscripts to reveal him as an ordinary man, moving away from the "idealized" version often taught in schools.
- The Four Guises of Rizal: Smita Lahiri identifies four distinct "personalities" of Rizal in the Philippine consciousness: the Novelist, the Hero, the Myth, and the Spirit.
 - The Mythic Rizal: "Rizalista" societies view him as a Filipino Christ or a shamanic figure who will one day return from Mt. Makiling to liberate the nation.
 - The Spirit Rizal (Amang Doktor): On Mt. Banahaw, pilgrims report encounters with "Amang Doktor," a wizened, crotchety spirit who performs cures using professional medical paraphernalia, representing a "ghostly commentary" on Rizal's elite credentials.
- The Inclusive Identity: In mystical seminars, some view Rizal as a symbol of a pluralistic nation, where his Chinese-mestizo roots are used to challenge xenophobic versions of nationalism.

V. Conclusion: The Real Goal of De-colonization

The sources suggest that the ultimate goal for the Filipino people is not merely to worship Rizal, but to achieve true de-colonization. This requires a socially responsible citizenry (a "nation of Rizals") who move beyond the personal indifference of characters like Basilio—who only joined the cause after his personal ambitions were thwarted—to work for the common national good. Only when the "dream has become a reality" will Rizal be truly honored by becoming obsolete.

Screenshot:

The screenshot displays the NotebookLM web application interface. The top navigation bar includes a search icon, a tab for 'Our Task: To Make Rizal Obsolete', and a URL. Below the navigation bar, the interface is divided into three main sections: Sources, Chat, and Studio.

Sources: This section on the left lists the sources used for the notebook. It includes a search bar and a list of sources with checkboxes for selection. The sources listed are 'Constantino, Renato, Our Task - To Make Rizal Obsolete...', 'Veneration Without Understanding.pdf', and 'addu-rizal-MODULE8.pdf'.

Chat: The central section shows a chat interface with a prompt: 'Create a note for these 3 PDF files. Make sure not to skip any major details. Highlight the important texts. Do not oversimplify the notes, add many information as possible.' Below the prompt, a generated note titled 'Comprehensive Note on the Life, Works, and Legacy of Jose Rizal' is displayed. The note includes a section 'I. The Task of Making Rizal Obsolete' and discusses the continued validity of Rizal's teachings, the social mirror he described, and the goal of obsolescence. It also lists modern parallels in Rizal's characters, such as 'Tulisanes in Cadillacs', 'Don Timoteo Palaez', 'One-Armed Bandits', and 'Social Archetypes'.

Studio: The right section shows the Studio interface, which includes a grid of icons for various output formats: Audio Overview, Slide Deck, Video Overview, Mind Map, Reports, Flashcards, Quiz, Infographic, and Data Table. Below the grid, a message states: 'Studio output will be saved here. After adding sources, click to add Audio Overview, Study Guide, Mind Map, and more!' and an 'Add note' button.

AI-Assisted Prompt

LLM used: ChatGPT

Create comprehensive, well-structured notes based on the three provided PDF files.

Requirements:

- *Do NOT skip any major concepts, definitions, examples, or explanations.*
- *Preserve important details, including supporting arguments, data, and key terminology.*
- *Do NOT oversimplify — aim for depth and completeness while remaining clear.*

Formatting:

- *Organize notes using clear headings and subheadings per topic.*
- *Use bullet points for readability, but include full explanations where necessary.*
- *Highlight or emphasize key terms, definitions, and important statements (e.g., using bold or ALL CAPS).*
- *Include summaries at the end of each major section.*
- *If applicable, extract and clearly present:*
 - *Definitions*
 - *Theories or principles*
 - *Processes or step-by-step explanations*
 - *Examples or case studies*

Output Quality:

- *Ensure logical flow and organization across all three PDFs.*
- *Merge overlapping topics instead of repeating them.*
- *Maintain accuracy and stay faithful to the original content.*
- *Use concise but information-dense language.*

Optional Enhancements:

- *Add a final “Key Takeaways” section summarizing the most critical insights.*
- *Include connections between topics if they are related across the PDFs.*

The LLM Output:

Comprehensive Study Notes: The Life, Works, and Legacy of Jose Rizal

I. The Controversy of the National Hero: Veneration vs. Understanding

Renato Constantino challenges the traditional, uncritical adoration of Jose Rizal, arguing that "veneration without understanding" leads to a superficial national identity.

- **THE REPUDIATION OF THE REVOLUTION:** Unlike heroes of other nations (e.g., Washington, Lenin, Ho Chi Minh) who led their revolutions, Rizal explicitly REPUDIATED the 1896 Philippine Revolution.
 - The December 15, 1896 Manifesto: In this document, Rizal condemned the uprising as "criminal" and "absurd," offering his services to Spain to stifle the rebellion.
 - Philosophical Stand: Rizal believed reforms must come from "above" (the elite/Spain) to be beneficial; he viewed movements from "below" (the masses) as uncertain and irregular.
- **AMERICAN SPONSORSHIP OF THE RIZAL CULT:** Rizal's pre-eminence is partly attributed to official promotion by the U.S. colonial administration under Governor WILLIAM HOWARD TAFT.
 - Reasons for Choice: The Americans favored Rizal over more radical figures like Bonifacio or Mabini because Rizal was "SAFELY DEAD," a non-combatant reformer, and did not advocate for immediate independence.
 - Legislative Acts: Acts of the Philippine Commission (Act No. 137, 243, and 346) institutionalized Rizal through the naming of provinces, monuments, and official days of observance.
- **THE INDIVIDUAL VS. HISTORICAL FORCES:** Constantino posits that while Rizal was a "great catalyzer," the nationalist movement was an inevitable result of social relations and economic developments of the 19th century.
 - Principle: If Rizal had not existed, another talent would have emerged to articulate the people's aspirations because leaders are impelled by historical forces, not just personal will.

Section Summary: The elevation of Rizal as the primary national hero was a strategic colonial choice to promote a "safe" model of reform rather than revolution, creating a contradiction between the hero and the birth of the nation.

II. The Evolution of "Filipino" Identity and Class Limitations

The term "Filipino" underwent a significant metamorphosis driven by material conditions and shifts in consciousness.

- **METAMORPHOSIS OF THE TERM "FILIPINO":**
 - Original Definition: The term originally referred only to CREOLES (Spaniards born in the Philippines).
 - Indios and Mestizos: The native population were called "Indios". It was only in the late 19th century that urbanized Indios and Chinese-mestizos began to appropriate the name "Filipino".
 - The "Indios Bravos": Rizal and his contemporaries in Europe transformed the derogatory "Indio" into a "badge of honor," winning the name for the natives as an anti-colonial victory in the realm of consciousness.
- **THE "LIMITED" FILIPINO (ILUSTRADO CLASS):**
 - Class Bias: Rizal was an ILUSTRADO (the "enlightened" elite), separated from the masses by property, education, and culture.
 - Reformism vs. Independence: Rizal viewed liberty as a "medal for good behavior" to be earned through education rather than an inherent national right. He desired liberties *within* the Spanish system rather than total political independence.
 - Comparison: While Rizal represented consciousness without a movement, Andres Bonifacio and the Katipunan represented the unity of revolutionary consciousness and practice.

Section Summary: Rizal successfully won the title "Filipino" for the natives, but his vision remained limited by his elite upbringing, leading him to favor reform over the mass-led de-colonization effort.

III. The Social Mirror: Making Rizal Obsolete

Constantino argues that the continued "timeliness" of Rizal's social critiques is a sign of national stagnation.

- **THE CONCEPT OF OBSOLESCENCE:** To truly honor Rizal, the nation must eradicate the social ills he decried so that his works become a "mirror of the past" rather than a "reproach to the present".
- **MODERN ARCHETYPES IN RIZAL'S CHARACTERS:**
 - Tulasanes in Cadillacs: Simoun's observation that the real bandits are not in the mountains but in the cities is reflected in modern corrupt officials and profiteers who treat government as a "milking cow".
 - Don Timoteo Pelaez: Represents devious business practices and the use of political influence to create artificial market needs for profit.
 - The One-Armed Man: The 19th-century version of modern FIXERS and influence peddlers.

- Social Climbers and Conformists: Modern society still hosts the Dona Victorinas (who belittle Filipinos), Capitan Tiagos (who fawn upon power), and Senor Pastas (who live in compromise).
- THE BASILIO SYNDROME:
 - Definition: The "Basilio" represents the timid, asocial individual who prioritizes personal ambition and "peace" over social justice.
 - Result: Such individuals "temporize with tyranny" and look the other way in the face of corruption, eventually degenerating into anti-social behavior.

Section Summary: The goal of the modern Filipino should be to build a "Nation of Rizals"—citizenry with social conscience—rather than a nation of indifferent "Basilios," thereby making Rizal's critiques obsolete.

IV. Culture, Language, and Intellectual Captivity

Rizal warned that adopting a foreign language as the primary medium of communication leads to national "originality" being smothered.

- LANGUAGE AS THOUGHT: Simoun argued that a people preserve the "marks of its liberty" as long as they preserve their language.
- INTELLECTUAL CAPTIVITY: Using English (or Spanish previously) as a basic means of communication opens the nation to a "cultural invasion" without defenses.
 - Consequences: Filipinos become an "uprooted race" with tenuous connections to the past, adopting foreign standards inappropriate for a struggling economy.
 - Mediocrity: Inadequate grasp of a foreign language results in the acquisition of only the "most banal aspects" of that culture, producing "semi-literate professionals".

Section Summary: True de-colonization requires reclaiming national originality through language, as foreign mediums result in intellectual captivity and a distorted national soul.

V. Beyond the Icon: Humanization, Myth, and Spirit

Modern perspectives seek to move beyond the "sanctified" image of Rizal to understand his multifaceted impact on Philippine culture.

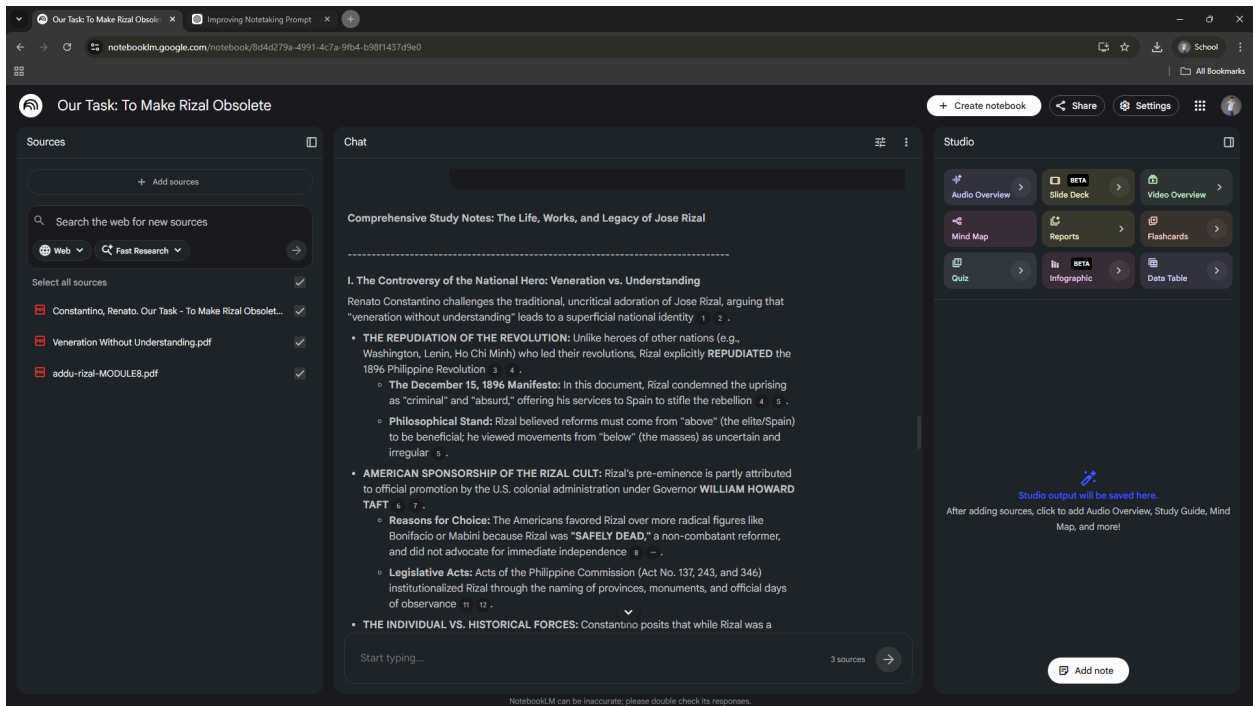
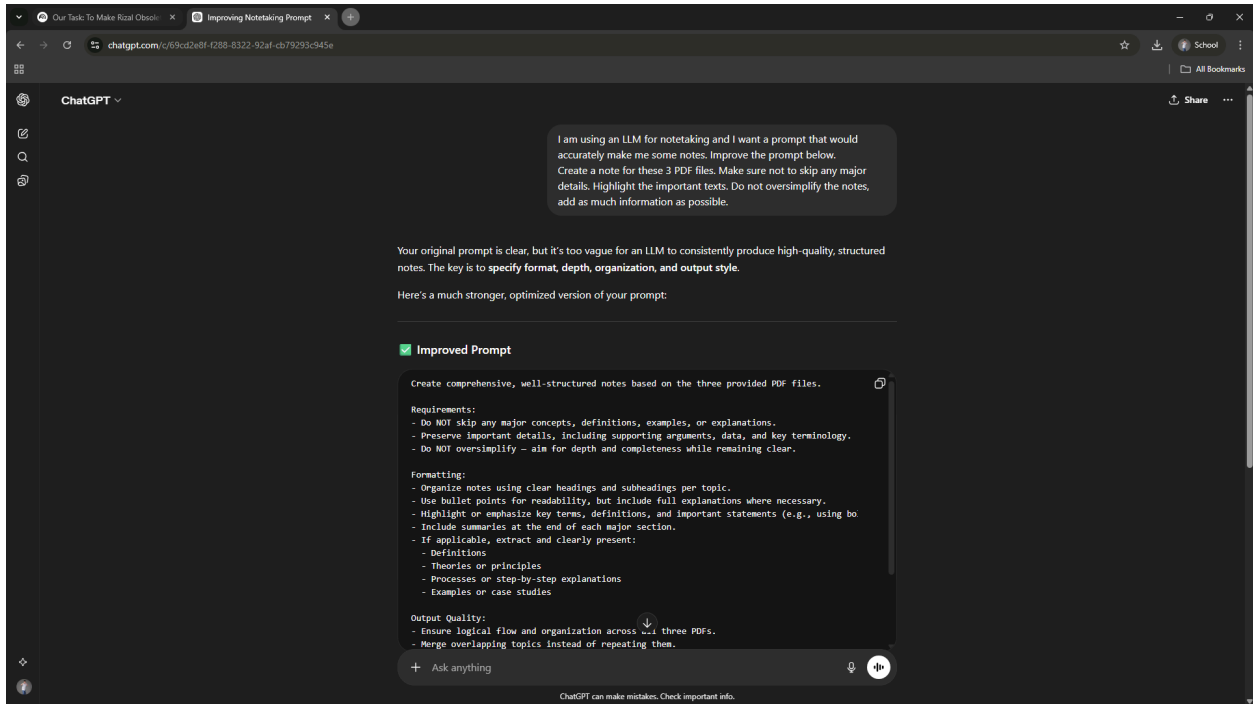
- RIZAL WITHOUT THE OVERCOAT (Ambeth Ocampo):
 - Goal: To humanize Rizal by examining original manuscripts and artifacts, moving away from the "idealized" version found in school curricula.
 - Purpose: To present facts that allow people to see Rizal as an ordinary man, which paradoxically makes his achievements more remarkable.
- THE FOUR GUISES OF RIZAL (Smita Lahiri):
 - 1. The Novelist: The urbane, ironical social critic.
 - 2. The Hero: The official, "normalized" national icon.
 - 3. The Myth: The "Filipino Christ" of Rizalista societies who will re-emerge from Mt. Makiling to liberate the nation.
 - 4. The Spirit (Amang Doktor): On Mt. Banahaw, pilgrims report encounters with "Amang Doktor," a wizened spirit who performs cures using professional medical tools.
- THE PLURALISTIC NATIONAL SYMBOL: In mystical seminars, Rizal's Chinese-mestizo roots are used to promote a "pluralistic" and inclusive idea of the nation, challenging xenophobic or "pure" versions of nationalism.

Section Summary: Rizal exists in Philippine consciousness not just as a historical figure, but as a evolving mythic and spiritual entity that continues to be reinterpreted to suit various social and spiritual needs.

Key Takeaways

- DE-COLONIZATION IS ONGOING: Being "Filipino" is a developing concept; the true Filipino of today must be consciously striving for de-colonization beyond mere racial identity.
- THE ROLE OF EDUCATION: While Rizal prioritized education as a prerequisite for liberty, modern critics argue that people educate themselves *through* the struggle for freedom.
- SOLIDARITY OVER INDIVIDUALISM: The current national task is to transition from a collection of "asocial" individuals (Basilios) to a unified nation with a social conscience.
- HISTORICAL RATIONALITY: We must view Rizal historically and critically, recognizing his limitations as an Ilustrado while honoring his role as a "great catalyzer" in the metamorphosis of the Filipino people.

Screenshot:



Comparison and Analysis

The outputs generated from the original prompt and the AI-assisted prompt show clear differences in terms of structure, clarity, depth, and overall usefulness. While both outputs contained accurate information about Jose Rizal and the related readings, the second output (from the improved prompt) was significantly more organized and detailed.

One major difference observed was in formatting and structure. The original output presented the information in a somewhat linear format with headings, but the improved output introduced clearer section divisions, consistent use of headings, emphasized key terms (such as capitalized concepts), and included section summaries and a “Key Takeaways” portion. This made the second output easier to read, scan, and review for studying purposes.

In terms of usefulness and accuracy, both outputs were accurate, but the improved output was more useful because it presented the information in a way that supports learning. The addition of summaries and highlighted concepts helped emphasize the most important ideas, making it more effective as a study material rather than just a general summary.

The improved prompt also had a strong impact on clarity, depth, and relevance. Clarity was enhanced through better organization and formatting instructions. Depth improved because the prompt explicitly required the inclusion of definitions, explanations, and supporting details. Relevance was maintained by instructing the AI to avoid unnecessary repetition and to merge related ideas across the PDFs.

Specific changes in the prompt that led to better results include the use of clear instructions, structured formatting requirements, and explicit output expectations. For example, specifying the use of headings, bullet points, and summaries guided the AI in producing a more well-organized response. Additionally, including constraints such as “do not oversimplify” and “preserve important details” ensured that the output remained comprehensive.

From this activity, I learned that prompt engineering plays a critical role in shaping AI outputs. A vague prompt can still produce correct information, but a well-designed prompt significantly improves the quality, usability, and presentation of the result. By adding structure, clarity, and specific instructions, users can guide AI tools to produce outputs that better meet their needs.